

Voorbeeld kunstobject

heb gemaakt om het object te testen: papier, perforatie, binding, opmaak en scheurgedrag. Hij bevat uitsluitend twee eigen werken, gemaakt voor avonden bij mogelijkheden open studio, en is gedrukt in een handvol exemplaren voor eigen gebruik. Er zijn geen andere makers bij betrokken, er zijn geen honoraria betaald en er heeft geen presentatie of verkoop plaatsgevonden.

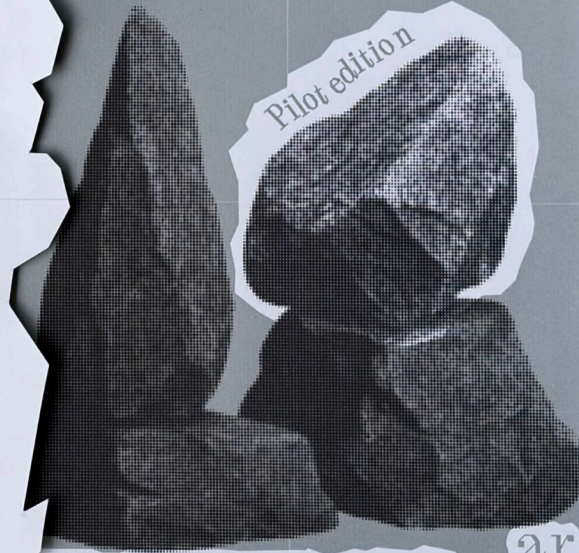
De proefeditie is dus eerder werk en geen onderdeel van het project waarvoor ik subsidie aanvraag. Geen van de kosten ervan staat in de begroting. Editie 01, met vijf makers, een redacteur, een oplage van 350 en een releasedag, begint pas na de vanaf-datum van het AFK. Wat deze proef laat zien is alleen dat de vorm werkt.

Artefact

Artefact

Preserving event-based design

Pilot edition



Includes 10 tear-out posters
and the stories behind them

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A group of people who share something agree on a feeling, a sound, a reason to gather. They ask someone to make a design that carries their shared idea, and that person has to hold all of it at once: the people, the vision, how the event should feel, the place it happens. As you read this, someone somewhere is doing exactly that. Before the night exists anywhere else, it exists as a design.

This is event-based design: work made to announce one happening, at one moment, in one place. It moves fast and asks a lot. Each event requires visual authenticity, the work has to feel true to the scene it speaks for. Briefs land late, sometimes days before the doors open. That pressure keeps it at the front of design.

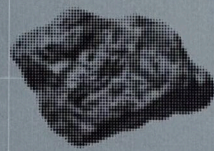
Picture how much of this type of design gets made around the world every week. Yet, so little survives the date on the poster. It does its job in days. A wall, a feed, a hand at the door, then the night comes and it has already moved on.

What disappears with the paper is the proof. Not just the design, but the record of how a moment looked: what a scene found beautiful, how it wanted to be seen. Scenes rarely have the money or reason to archive themselves, so the memory goes a piece at a time.



Why do we treat event-based design differently than other design? Nothing in the work itself expires. A poster with a past date, one with a date still to come, one with no date at all, the design holds the same weight whichever way the day falls. Event-based design is timeless. Yet we seem to treat it with the same due date as the event on it.

Artefact ignores the due date. We value these works as cultural milestones and treat them that way: each design shown at full size, named, dated, placed. The date stays, because it tells you where a work comes from, not when to stop looking. We sit down with the makers, and where it adds to the story, with the people who made the night happen. Work made at speed gets set down with the care its speed never allowed, so it can be preserved instead of lost, by people who were there and people who never were.



Each edition of Artefact looks through one lens. Sometimes that is a scene. Sometimes a city, a year, a single venue that mattered. One edition never tells the whole story and is not meant to. They stack. Read across enough of them and the archive becomes a record of many worlds at once, each one kept on its own terms.

Inside are the works and the people who made them, maps that put each piece back where it happened, and posters you can tear out for a wall of your own choosing. This is something to keep, just not in one piece. The moment you tear it out, a lost artefact is given back its place in cultural history. Thank you for archiving with us!

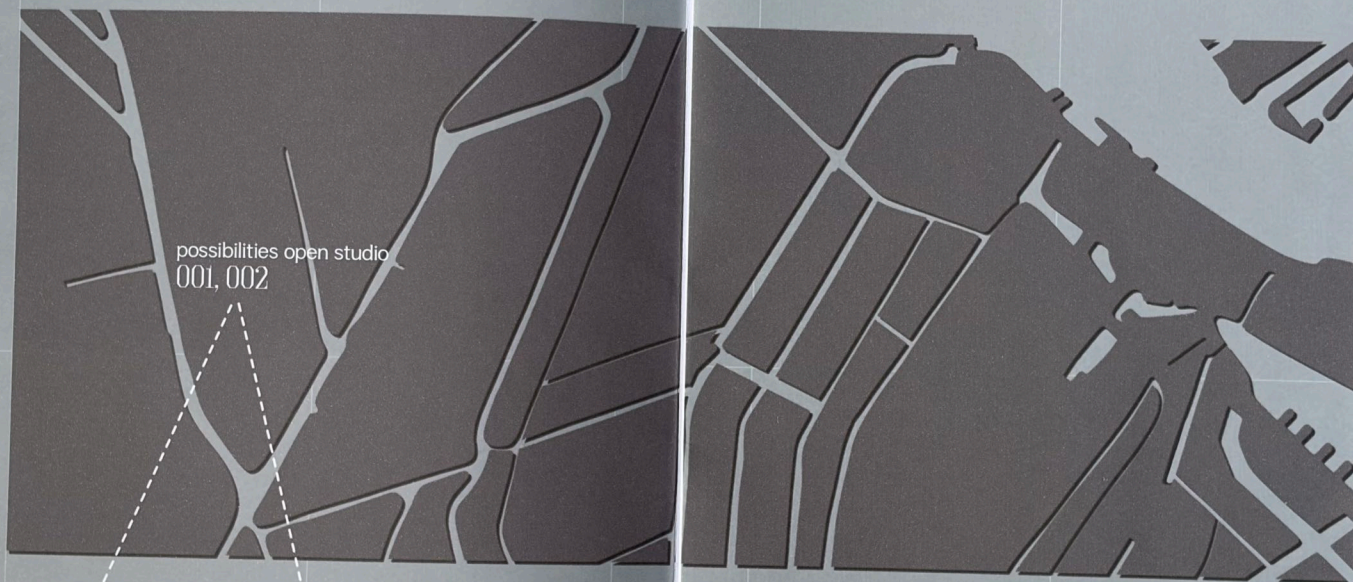


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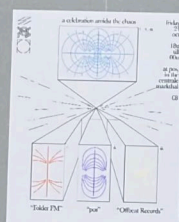
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pos artworks by me

Number of preservation sites
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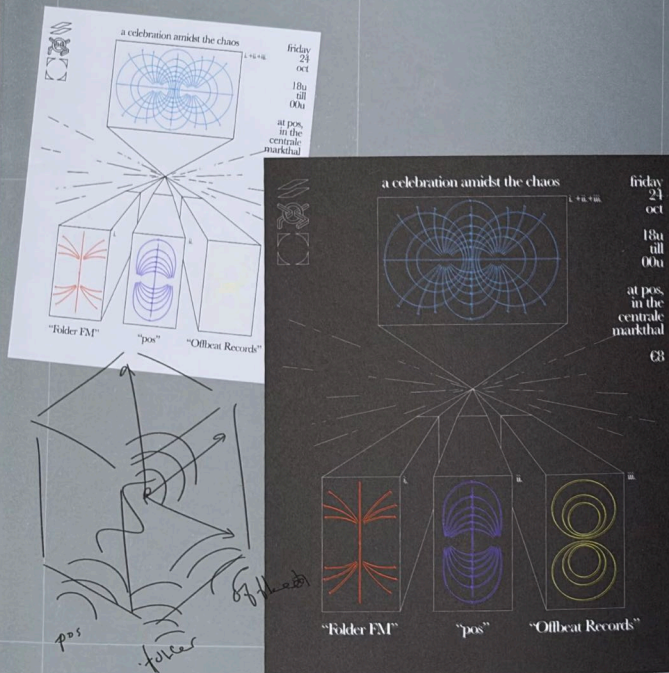
possibilities open studio
001, 002



Artefact 001 Designer Oscar Nowak

Medium: hand-drawn, Procreate, print and online Event: pos & folder fm & offbeat records Date: 24 October 2025 Organiser: possibilities open studio, folder fm, offbeat records Venue: possibilities open studio, Amsterdam Scene: grassroots, experimental electronics, radio, vinyl

A drawing for a night where three collectives shared one room, built around meeting, eating and dancing rather than a single headline act. The poster had to announce a gathering, not a lineup.



This night was three collectives in one room, with food at the centre of it. How do you draw a collaboration, when the thing you're announcing is several groups agreeing to share a space rather than one act performing?

I wanted the trio to look like one thing without losing what each of them is. I take a lot from nature and physics, and I found it in an electromagnetic wave. I disassembled the wave and gave each collective a part: (a) Folder FM, a radio station, an antenna. (b) pos, a space to gather, a round connecting form. (c) Offbeat Records, a record store, two vinyl shapes. Apart, three things. Together, the wave.

There's no photography here, no lineup grid, no club-flyer conventions. It's hand-drawn. What does drawing by hand promise a person that a designed flyer doesn't?

The medium is personal preference. There's no right material for a flyer. Leaving out the lineup is the real choice, and that comes from pos. pos works towards a different use of music events, where you come to discover whoever is playing instead of chasing names. So we post the collectives, not the lineup.

The night described itself as happening "amidst the chaos of the city." Where does that sit in the drawing, and did you draw the chaos or the shelter from it?

That's about ADE more than the illustration. The largest electronic music event in the world, in a small city, heavily commercialised. Amsterdam struggles with the mess and the tourists, events get pushed to their limit to make money, and small artists and venues get buried in it. pos decided not to take part. We organised an alternative instead, with more care and more room for people to get in.

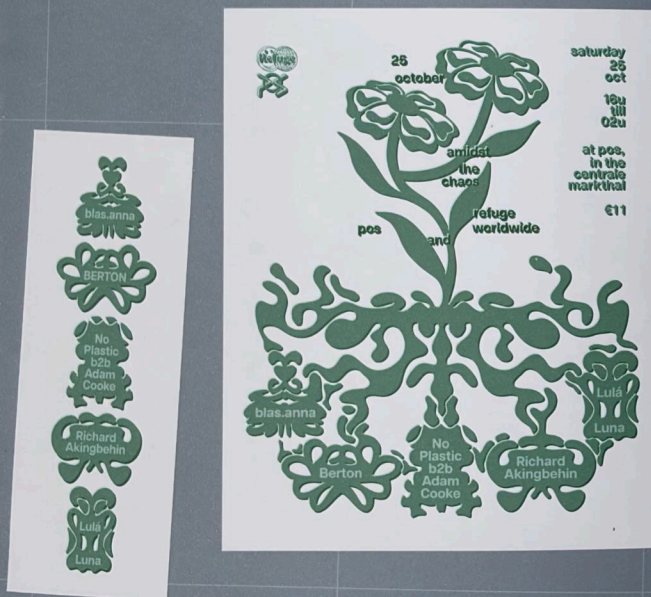
If someone finds this poster in ten years knowing nothing about the collectives on it, what should still be legible to them?

I hope they feel the connection. Separate parts making something bigger than themselves.

Artefact 002 Designer Oscar Nowak

Medium: hand-drawn, Procreate, physical poster, online Event: pos & refuge worldwide Date: 25 October 2025 Organiser: possibilities open studio, refuge worldwide Venue: possibilities open studio, Amsterdam Scene: club, dub, electronic, grassroots and sound system culture, Berlin

A drawing for a Berlin-Amsterdam lineup rooted in dub and sound system culture, made for a night built on bass and blurred boundaries. The poster had to carry weight and frequency rather than announce names, and hold two collectives meeting each other for the first time.



A lineup carrying sound system culture is about weight and frequency, things you feel rather than see. How do you draw something that's fundamentally physical?

I drew the feeling I already had about it. I was organising too, so I knew the night came out of connection, two collectives who care deeply about music starting a relationship. You know the separate parts will meet and make something. I didn't want to lose the character of each artist, so each one got an icon. The icons are also roots, sprouting into one flower.

Half this lineup came from Berlin, half from Amsterdam. Did the poster need to look like it belonged to both cities, or to neither?

Inside a shared moment the boundary between two cities doesn't matter much. Both teams learnt from each other, took on each other's ways of working, and yes, it was made across two cities. But deeper down there were no boundaries. I hope the drawing shows that.

Refuge Worldwide is itself a radio station and an archive. Did knowing you were designing for people who already preserve things change your view on creating this?

Refuge has been an inspiration to me and to others at pos. A more matured grassroots space. Working with them gave me the energy to put more hours into a deeper concept. Knowing this would end up in an archive did feel like it added value to that.

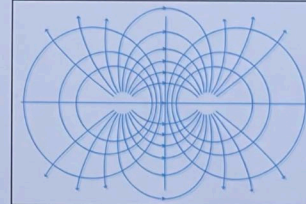
Part 2 Tear-out

Tear out: Artefact 001 by Oscar Nowak Edition, Summer 2026



a celebration amidst the chaos

i. + ii. + iii.

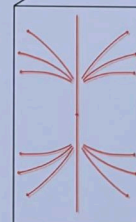


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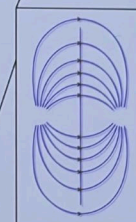
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"Folder FM"



"pos"



"Offbeat Records"

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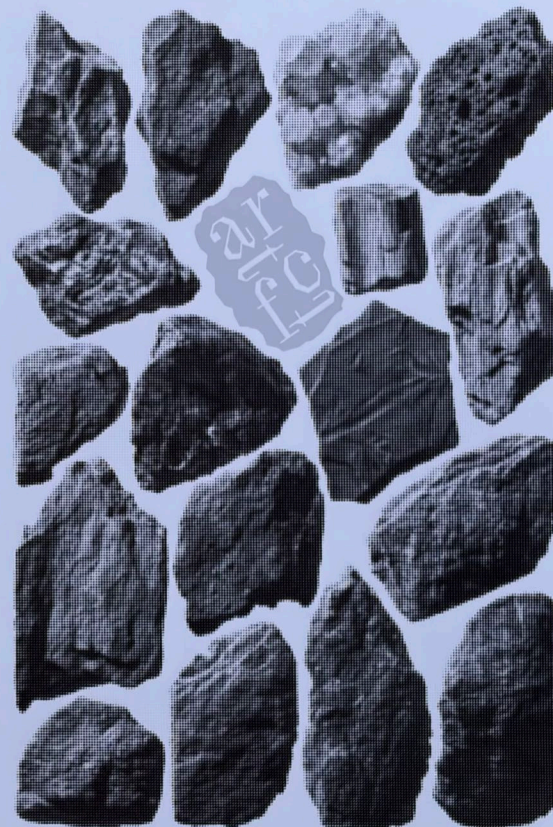


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Tear out: Pilot Edition, Summer 2026



Artefact

Pilot Edition, Summer 2026



Pilot Edition
Summer 2026

